

MERIDIAN HEALTH PLAN

Utilization Management | Notice of Adverse Benefit Determination

Date of Notice: 2026-07-14

Member: JOHNSTON, DARRON | Member ID: MHP-93EE1E59

Reference / Auth #: PA-2026-0714-92416

Ordering Provider: Priya Natarajan, MD — Cedar Grove Family Medicine

Requested Service: MRI Lumbar Spine without contrast (CPT 72148)

Diagnosis: M54.50 — Low back pain

Determination: DENIED

Denial Reason Code: AD-01 — Requested Clinical Documentation Not Received

Rationale: The clinical documentation requested to support this prior authorization (recent office notes documenting symptom duration, physical examination findings, and conservative therapy attempted) was not received within the required timeframe. The request is administratively denied. Per Medical Policy MP-RAD-014, Section 4, the medical record must document symptom duration, conservative therapy modalities and duration, and objective examination findings.

Your Appeal Rights

You may submit a written appeal within 180 days of the date of this notice. A peer-to-peer review with a plan medical director may be requested within 14 days. Submit appeals to: Meridian Health Plan, Attn: Appeals Unit, PO Box 22140.